

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 3

A School System Pauses Student AI



Example 1 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Chalkbeat, CNN, CBS New York and The 74, September 2, 2026. Summary in our own words; no figures. Organizations named as reported; no private individuals.

THE STORY

New York City's public school system announced a new rule about generative AI, the kind of tool that writes text or makes images from a prompt. Under the rule, students from kindergarten through eighth grade will not use these tools for schoolwork this school year. Officials described the pause as lasting one school year. High schools get a different plan. Some high schools will try out approved AI tools in pilot programs. High school students will also take AI literacy lessons every year. The system is the largest in the country, so the rule reaches a very large number of students.

FRAME 3 FILLED IN • WRITE THE RULE — as a strong student would

Story: NYC schools pause student AI through grade 8
Where I saw it: Chalkbeat, then CNN **Date:** Sept. 2026

The question the rule has to answer: *Should K–8 students use AI for schoolwork?*

RULE	WHO IT HELPS	WHO IT HURTS	WHAT IT COSTS
1. Creative: pass an AI lesson first.	Kids who spot AI errors	Kids who have to wait	Time to teach it
2. Middle: only tasks a teacher picks.	Kids with a guide	Teachers who must plan	Class time
3. Strict: no other AI through grade 8.	Teachers grading real work	Kids who'd learn it safely	Freedom

The fix I made so the rules don't clash: *Strict was "no AI at all." Now it skips rule 2's tasks.*

Defend one rule, three sentences: *The rule is: pass an AI lesson before using AI. It matters because AI can make up facts. The story backs this up: its high school plan pairs the pilots with AI lessons every year.*

So what? *I'm in middle school. This rule decides if I learn AI with a teacher or alone on my phone.*

Why this frame: the story is a school system setting a rule, so the question is "what should the rule be," not "who was right." Frame 3 keeps students off the officeholders and on the grid, where every rule has a cost.

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 7

Musicians Sue an AI Music Company



Example 2 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Billboard, Rolling Stone, Variety, and The Hollywood Reporter, August 31, 2026. Summary in our own words; every claim in the case is alleged. Organizations named as reported; no private individuals.

THE STORY

A group of musicians filed a lawsuit against Suno, a company whose AI tool generates songs from a text prompt. They filed it as a proposed class action, which means they are asking to speak for many other musicians with the same complaint. The musicians allege that the tool can imitate a real artist's style and identity, meaning things like a voice or a name, without permission. A lawsuit is a list of claims that a court has not yet decided, so nothing in it is proven. In any lawsuit the side being sued gets a turn to answer, and the court decides after that. The case asks a question that comes up whenever AI learns from art: is copying a style like copying a song, or a singer?

FRAME 7 FILLED IN • COPY, STYLE, OR PERSON? — as a strong student would

Story: *Musicians sue Suno, an AI music company*

Where I saw it: *Billboard, then Variety* **Date:** *Aug. 31, 2026*

#	WHAT HAPPENED	SORTED AS
1	Traces a drawing line by line and posts it as their own.	☒ Work
2	Draws comics in the same anime style as a famous series: big eyes, bold lines.	☒ Style
3	Uses a singer's real voice to make a song that singer never sang.	☒ Person
4	Puts ten seconds of a hit song into a beat without asking.	☒ Work
5	Writes a story with the same plot as a famous book. Only the names change.	☒ Work
6	Makes a video where a real athlete's face says words they never said.	☒ Person
7	Cooks a dish "in the style of" a famous chef and sells it.	☒ Style
8	Learns a dance from a video and does it at the talent show.	☒ Work
9	<i>Copies a real singer's voice and style (the suit alleges).</i>	☒ Person

Where I draw the line: *Copying a style is fine when I make something new. It crosses the line at a voice or face.*

So what? *I make beats and covers. That's the line between a style I learned and a person I took.*

Why this frame: a lawsuit about copying is a sorting problem before it is a verdict. Frame 7 lets students sort work, style, and person without deciding the case, which no court has done either; every claim stays "alleged."

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 4

A Free Game-Data Site Changes Hands



Example 3 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by Engadget, PC Gamer, Kotaku, and heise, September 2, 2026. Summary in our own words; no figures. Organizations named as reported; no private individuals.

THE STORY

SteamDB is a free website that tracks information about games sold on Steam, such as price changes and how many people are playing. For years it was run by one person, mostly alone. That owner said running the site had led to burnout. The site was sold to the company that owns Nexus Mods, a large site where players share game modifications. The sale price was not made public. The new owner promised the site would stay free, with no ads and no paywall. Free sites still cost money to run. So if it stays free, who pays?

FRAME 4 FILLED IN • WHO PAYS FOR FREE? — as a strong student would

Story: *Free game-data site SteamDB is sold*

Where I saw it: *PC Gamer, then Engadget* **Date:** *Sept. 2026*

The free thing: *SteamDB, a free tracker for Steam games*

What it costs to run: *Servers and someone's time to keep it up*

WAY TO PAY THE BILLS	ONE GAIN FOR USERS	ONE LOSS FOR USERS	PICK
Donations	No ads; users call the shots	Money can dry up	☐
Ads	Free for everyone, for good	Slow pages and tracking	☐
Membership	Steady money to hire help	Best stuff behind a paywall	☐
Extras	Only fans who want more pay	Free users get less	☐
One sponsor	All bills covered at once	Sponsor could bend the data	☐
Taxes	Free for every player	Leaders decide what it covers	☐
Bigger owner	A team, not one tired person	It could break its promise	☒

Why I picked it: *I'd pick Bigger owner because the gain is a real team. I can live with the loss because they promised no ads and no paywall.*

So what? *Most of my apps are free. Somebody pays for each one. I want to know what I pay with.*

Why this frame: a free thing changing owners is Frame 4's whole question: if it's free, who pays? The grid turns one sale into seven choices, and each has a loss the student must name. Then push one step further: the new owner pays now, so how does it make that money?

WORKED EXAMPLES • SEPTEMBER 2026 • FRAME 9

An AI Helper Can Act on Your Photos



Example 4 of 4, teacher-facing. As reported by 9to5Google, TechCrunch, and PetaPixel, September 3, 2026. Summary in our own words; the kind of capability, not product tiers. Organizations named as reported; no private individuals.

THE STORY

Google announced that Gemini, its AI assistant, can now act inside a person's Google Photos library. Reports described it as an agent, which means a tool that carries out tasks for you rather than only telling you how. A user can ask it to find the photos they describe and take actions on them, and it does the steps. Some actions in a photo library are easy to undo; others, like deleting or sharing, are not. A photo library holds a lot about a person: faces, places, dates. That is why a helper that can act on it needs clear limits.

FRAME 9 FILLED IN • PERMISSION SLIP — as a strong student would

Story: *Google's Gemini can act in Google Photos*

Where I saw it: *TechCrunch, then 9to5Google* **Date:** *Sept. 2026*

#	THE AI HELPER COULD...	MY CHOICE	MY REASON — BECAUSE IT COULD...
1	Read all my messages to find one.	Check first	<i>read private stuff.</i>
2	Delete photos it thinks are blurry.	Check first	<i>delete a photo I love.</i>
3	Send a message to a friend, as me.	Check first	<i>send words I'd never say.</i>
4	Buy something with a saved card.	Deny	<i>spend money I can't get back.</i>
5	Change a password.	Deny	<i>lock me out of my account.</i>
6	Post to my account.	Check first	<i>post what I can't take back.</i>
7	Sort my photos into albums.	Allow	<i>only move them. I can undo.</i>
8	Share my location with a contact.	Deny	<i>tell someone where I am.</i>
9	<i>Find the photos I describe.</i>	Allow	<i>only look, not change.</i>
10	<i>Share the photos it finds.</i>	Check first	<i>share with the wrong person.</i>

The risky combo: *Rows 1 and 3 are fine alone. Together they could answer a private message as me.*

So what? *My photos know my face, my friends, and where I've been. A helper there needs my rules.*

Why this frame: an assistant that can act on a photo library is exactly what Frame 9 sorts: what may it do alone, what must it ask about, what never. The story supplies rows 9 and 10; the student supplies the limits and the risky combo.